Food Policy

The Green Party supports everyone's right to food that is safe, accessible, and affordable. For Māori, this includes the right to access and prepare food in traditional ways. Aotearoa New Zealand needs a national strategy for the whole food system that builds local resilience, reduces waste, and protects the climate. When there is enough food, and it is nourishing, it supports our health and wellbeing. We want to prepare and share meals with our family and friends. This will sustain and strengthen our family traditions and cultural practices.

Vision

Nourishing food is always local, affordable, safe, and sustainable for future generations.

Values and Principles

Food policy must follow these values and principles:

- *Whakamana*: Central and local government must support Māori to restore their food practices.
- *Rangatiratanga*: Everyone should have the right to autonomous decision-making over nourishing food systems.
- *Puawaitanga*: Nutritious food should be affordable for all, via a fair and robust supply chain.
- *Manaakitanga*: Everyone should have access to enough good food wherever they live.
- *Tikanga*: Food should be safe and nourishing. All steps of the food supply chain should be transparent and support cultural safety.
- *Ngā Hapori Tōnui*: Those who work within the supply chain should be the first to benefit.
- *Kaitiakitanga*: Food systems should promote healthy and biodiverse ecosystems and a safe climate.
- *Hauora*: Food should improve wellbeing for family and community. "He kai te rongoā, he rongoā te kai."
- *Manawaroa*: Food systems must be resilient and sustainable during natural and human-made disasters.

Strategic Priorities

The Green Party's strategic goals include:

"...regenerative practices in all areas of economic activity, including land use and food production, will predominate..."

Actions in this policy that will work towards this goal include:

- Create a national strategy for the whole food system that honours Te Tiriti o Waitangi and prioritises the health of people and the planet over economic goals. (1.3.)
- Provide free nutritious lunches for every school child, emphasising wholefood and plant-based options. (4.2.)
- Update the Eating and Activity Guidelines. Take a 'whole system' approach to food that includes environmental, social, and cultural issues. (4.3.)
- Set up a cross-government body with iwi, academics, and non-government organisations. This should oversee and lead food-related policies. (5.4.)
- Amend the food processing and selling regulations to make them fair and affordable for small local suppliers. (6.3.)
- Support higher levels of nutrition education for all healthcare providers. They should use that knowledge to meet individual health needs. (8.2.)

Connected Policies

See also our policies on:

- Ensuring sustainable and resilient commercial food production (Agriculture Policy; Climate Change Policy; Land Use and Soils Policy, Marine Policy, Trade and Foreign Investment Policy);
- The wider economy (Government in the Economy Policy; Sustainable Business Policy);
- Food-related technologies (Research, Science and Technology Policy); and
- A holistic, wellbeing-centred approach to health and wellbeing (Health Policy).

Policy Positions

1. Whakamana

Our Vision

We value the life-giving qualities of food and honour its connection to the natural world. We receive support to use our traditional ways and/or mātauranga Māori approaches to preparing and consuming wholefoods. This nurtures people and gives us hope for the future of the planet.

Actions

1.1. Expand programs that teach children to grow and harvest food from school gardens, and teach them to prepare and share nutritious meals.
1.2. Strengthen and prioritise restoring the Māori-led kaitiakitanga of mahinga kai.
1.3. Create a national strategy for the whole food system that honours Te Tiriti o Waitangi and prioritises the health of people and the planet over economic goals.

2. Rangatiratanga

Our Vision

Māori food sovereignty is strong and supports food security and resilience. The agency of all consumers is upheld. We can make informed food decisions, supported by clear, accessible information. A wide range of options close to where we live lets us choose foods that meet our cultural needs. We know how to prepare and eat nourishing foods.

Actions

2.1. Support tangata whenua practices around food production, distribution, and decision-making.
2.2. Support the foods and practices that reflect mana whenua.
2.3. Ensure that consumers have access to accurate information on the environmental impact and other ethical considerations of their food.
2.4. Revise relevant legislation to protect the human right to be free from hunger and malnutrition.

3. Puawaitanga

Our Vision

The foods that we need every day are affordable. We have easy access to nutritious food that is plentiful and fresh. We have the resources we need to access and share the food we want, without being reliant on others to meet that need. This means that we all enjoy high levels of economic, physical, and social wellbeing.

Actions

3.1. Provide support to community food hubs, distribution programmes, and other local food initiatives.
3.2. Strengthen legislation to end anti-competitive behaviours across the grocery sector.
3.3. Make nourishing food and drinks more affordable and easier to access.

4. Manaakitanga

Our Vision

Everyone can access nourishing and diverse food close to where we live and work. There is enough food to support our health and wellbeing. We can also provide hospitality to friends, family, and visitors. As a country, we prioritise our domestic supply of the food we produce to feed our own people first.

Actions

4.1. Remove the fringe benefit tax from nourishing meals provided by employers.
4.2. Provide free nutritious lunches for every school child, emphasising wholefood and plant-based options.
4.3. Update the Eating and Activity Guidelines. Take a 'whole system' approach to food that includes environmental, social, and cultural issues.

5. Tikanga

Our Vision

Food and drinks meet our health and cultural needs. They must also meet our spiritual and/or religious requirements. Government agencies check that imported and commercial foods meet high standards of safety. There are regulations that prioritise the public health and wellbeing of all.

Actions

5.1. Renegotiate the Australia and New Zealand Food Standards Treaty. This must let Aotearoa New Zealand, including iwi, take full control over our own food regulations.
5.2. Improve the enforcement of imported foods. Hold these to the same standards as those required by Aotearoa New Zealand food producers.
5.3. Strengthen the Food Act to address longer-term risks to public health.
5.4. Set up a cross-government body with iwi, academics, and non-government organisations. This should oversee and lead food-related policies.

6. Ngā hapori tōnui

Our Vision

We have a reliable, year-round food supply from local farmers' markets and community gardens. The food is in-season, fresh, and produced in a sustainable way. Local suppliers' prices are competitive with supermarkets, which provides ongoing food security.

Actions

6.1. Support community-led and tangata whenua-led approaches to growing resilient local food economies.
6.2. Include food-sensitive and urban design concepts in council planning policies by signing up to the Milan Food Pact so that they:
    6.2.1. Cover fresh and wholefood outlets in areas that don't have many, and
    6.2.2. Support communities to access land to grow food.
6.3. Amend the food processing and selling regulations to make them fair and affordable for small local suppliers.
6.4. Prioritise local food suppliers for public institutions (e.g. prisons, hospitals, schools).

7. Kaitiakitanga

Our Vision

Each step in the food supply chain achieves net-zero greenhouse gas emissions. We act to reduce the food supply chain's impacts on the natural world and on climate change. This informs our dietary choices, and our diet is primarily wholefood and plant-based.

Actions

7.1. Use social marketing campaigns to show how people's food choices impact climate change.
7.2. Reduce polluting packaging and energy and water use in the food supply chain. This will lower greenhouse gas emissions.
7.3. Install technologies that can measure and reduce food waste at all points in the supply chain.

8. Hauora

Our Vision

Nourishing food is easy to find, especially high-nutrient, minimally processed, plant-based options. This supports our physical and mental health and family and community wellbeing. Access to these food options has an extra benefit of lowering demand on our health system.

Actions

8.1. Commit to the Global Compact for Non-Communicable Diseases 2023-2030. This requires a renewed focus on a nourishing diet.
8.2. Support higher levels of nutrition education for all healthcare providers. They should use that knowledge to meet individual health needs.
8.3. Create a National Policy Statement to regulate food marketing to protect public health.

9. Manawaroa

Our Vision

We can rely on a sustainable food supply in a natural disaster. A strong local food system supports the resilience of our community in an emergency. Disruptions will not affect the supply of our varied nutritional needs from food.

Actions

9.1. Support marae and other hubs to stockpile food to meet all community food requirements, during and following emergencies.
9.2. Support food distributors and retailers to provide rapid and secure food supplies in an emergency. This requires well-rehearsed systems, supply chain resilience, and trained personnel.
9.3. Continue distributing food if cash or card systems are not available in an emergency. Compensate all affected food providers as soon as possible afterwards.